COZY BEAR COTTAGE (小熊中文)

Visual design by Vivian McDonald

Bear team: Patrick McDonald · Vivian McDonald · Evelyn McDonald · Yukui McDonald · Xiaoyue He · Zhang Shun















EVERY WEEK, VOLUNTEER TEACHERS BUILD THE WHOLE CLASS BY HAND





Weekend Chinese schools across the US run on parent volunteers — no curriculum team, no illustrator, and no budget.

BY HAND, WEEKLY

A 45-minute lesson plan, flashcards, printable worksheets, and games that hold a 3-to-6-year-old's attention — rebuilt from scratch every week.

WRONG MATERIALS

Young children learn best from their own world — their cup, their dog, their drawing — not from generic stock flashcards.

FIRSTHAND

I run a Saturday Chinese class for ages 3–6 in Bear, Delaware, and I prepare every one of these materials myself, every week.



ONE CO-TEACHER PLANS, ILLUSTRATES, AND PLAYS



An AI co-teacher for parent-run weekend heritage-language classes, for kids ages 3–6.

LESSON BUILDER

Pick a theme and get the complete 45-minute lesson, ready to teach word for word.

LIVING FLASHCARDS

Every word illustrated in one friendly style, exported as a printable pack.

POINT-AND-SAY

Tap any real object and hear its Chinese name — learning from the child's own world.



Stretch, if time allows: a parent view with attendance and words mastered, so families can practise at home.





PICK A THEME, GET A COMPLETE 45-MINUTE LESSON

YOU CHOOSE

- Age range: 3–6
- Theme: colors, animals, numbers, family…
- This Saturday: colors

Powered by Muse Spark

YOU RECEIVE

- Opening song
- Word set — characters, pinyin, English
- A story and two games
- Bilingual teaching script to follow word for word









EVERY WORD BECOMES A PRINTABLE PACK IN ONE STYLE

- Muse Image illustrates each word in one consistent style, anchored by this same white bear — the little bear teacher
- Flashcards for the lesson
- Trace-the-character worksheets and coloring pages
- One click exports a print-ready PDF pack









TAP ANYTHING. HEAR IT IN CHINESE. SAY IT BACK.



TAP A RED CUP

SAM 3.1 segments the object a child taps, in a photo or through the camera.

红色 – HÓNG SÈ

Muse Spark names it in Chinese with pinyin and speaks it aloud: “红色, hóng sè — red!”

REPEAT, EARN A STAR

The child repeats it and earns a star and a cheer. Target words are celebrated when found.



BUILT ON META AI — EVERY TOOL DOES ESSENTIAL WORK



MUSE SPARK	Lesson planning and teaching scripts, naming objects in context, and practice sentences at a 3–6-year-old's level.
MUSE IMAGE	The full flashcard and worksheet illustration set, in one consistent bear-teacher style.
SAM 3.1	Tap-to-segment recognition via the Meta Model API — the core interaction behind Point-and-Say.
MUSE CODE	Used in the build itself, by the project team.

Remove any one tool and the product breaks.





OUR TEACHING DATASET

Source: Chinese Playtime by Kristen Czyszek, with Lulu the Panda & Lenny the Koala — 203K followers on Facebook, 91.7K on Instagram.

111 song videos collected — 40 on Facebook + 71 on Instagram — covering **66 themed sing-along lessons**.

GREETINGS
你好 · 你好吗 · 我很好

Hello · How are you? · I'm good

COUNTING 1–10
一 · 二 · 三 · 四 · 五 · 六 · 七 · 八 · 九 · 十

One to ten, sung with Lenny the Koala

SEVEN COLOURS
红色 · 蓝色 · 黄色 · 绿色 · 橙色 · 紫色 · 粉红色

Red · blue · yellow · green · orange · purple · pink

ACTION WORDS
跳 · 跑 · 走 · 坐 · 站 · 转 · 拍手

Jump · run · walk · sit · stand · turn · clap

FAMILY
妈妈 · 爸爸 · 哥哥 · 姐姐 · 弟弟 · 妹妹 · 宝宝

Mum · dad · big brother · big sister · little brother · little sister · baby

TRANSPORT
汽车 · 巴士 · 火车 · 自行车 · 船 · 飞机

Car · bus · train · bicycle · boat · plane

EMOTIONS
快乐 · 难过 · 生气 · 害怕

Happy · sad · angry · scared

DAILY ROUTINE
起床 · 刷牙 · 洗脸 · 上学

Get up · brush teeth · wash face · go to school





How Cozy Bear Cottage uses it: each song maps to a lesson plan, its Living Flashcards, and Point-and-Say practice words for the Saturday class, ages 3–6.



FEASIBLE IN 10 DAYS — OCT 26 TO NOV 4

OCT 26–27	Skeleton app and Meta Model API wiring. Lesson Builder end-to-end, starting with colors.
OCT 28–29	Living Flashcards — style lock-in, flashcard and worksheet PDF export.
OCT 30–NOV 1	Point-and-Say — SAM 3.1 tap segmentation, naming and audio loop, star rewards.
NOV 2–3	Test with next Saturday's real lesson, polish, offline fallbacks, and record the demo.
NOV 4	Final demo and write-up, submitted before 9:00 pm ET.

Demo: generate Saturday's colors lesson live, watch the printables appear, then tap a red cup.





DESIGNED BY VIVIAN

Visual design by Vivian McDonald — her artwork gives Cozy Bear Cottage its colors.











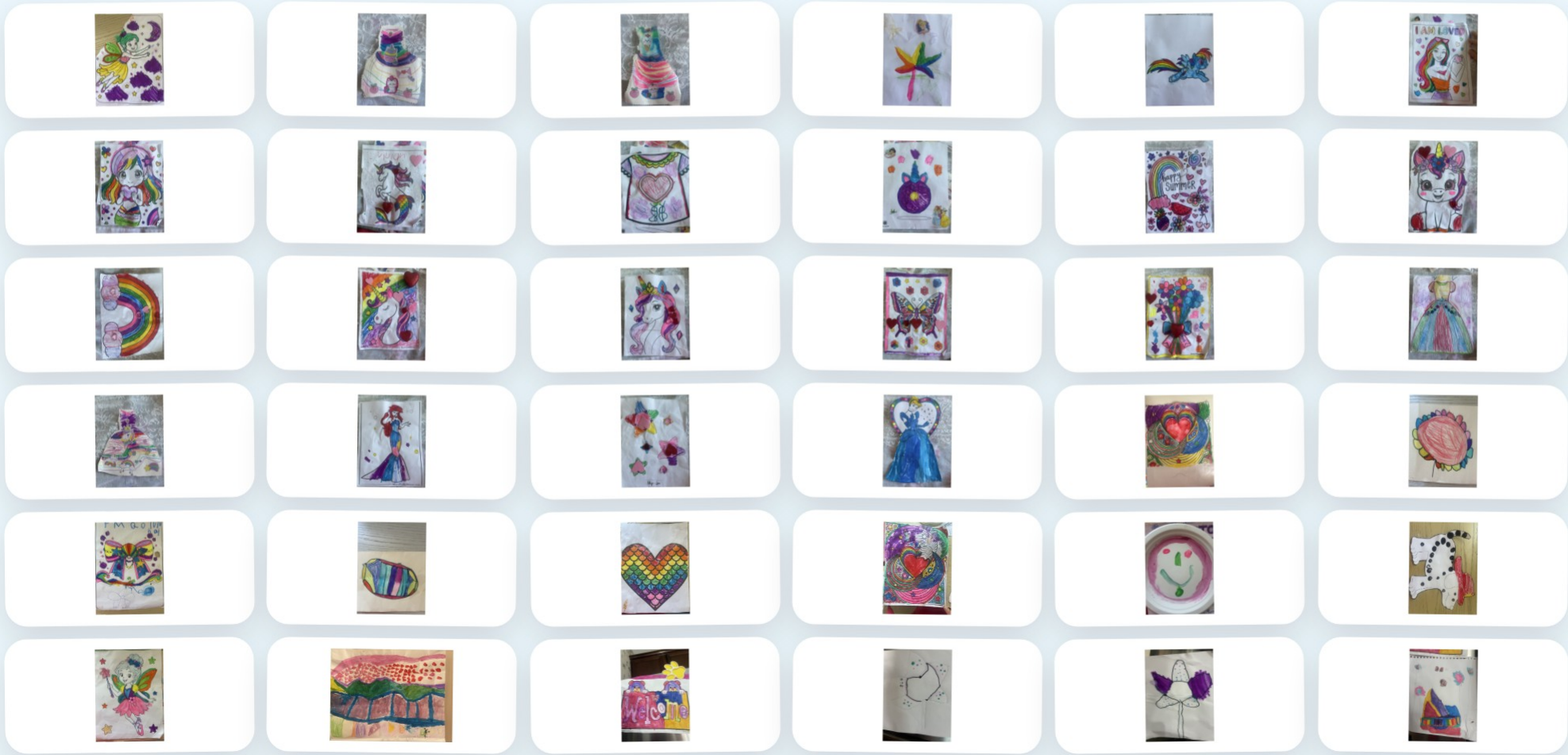





Vivian McDonald, visual designer, at work.

DESIGNED BY VIVIAN

Visual design by Vivian McDonald — 48 artworks in her complete portfolio.









BY AGE SIX



CHILDREN WHO DON'T USE THEIR HOME LANGUAGE OFTEN LOSE IT

Weekend schools are the main defence, and they run on exhausted volunteers.

“Every weekend-school parent in America is preparing tonight's class by hand. Cozy Bear Cottage does it in two minutes.”

Impact · Meta tooling · Demo · Technical depth — Cozy Bear Cottage （小熊中文） · Indie track · Build for Your World



TECHNICAL STACK

- Mobile-first web app — React + Vite (PWA)
- Web Speech API — spoken Chinese for Point-and-Say
- HTML-to-PDF print pipeline — flashcards and worksheets
- Meta Model API — Muse Spark · Muse Image · SAM 3.1
- Lightweight serverless backend — API proxy + lesson content store
- Built with Muse Code

Visual design by Vivian McDonald



THE END

